



Hawker Hurricane Mk1 UK 1936

Eight Browning machine guns mounted in wings

Powerful Daimler engine generates top speed of about 354 mph (570 km/h)



Messerschmitt Bf 109E Germany 1938

The Bf 109 was the most produced fighter plane—**33,984** were built between 1936 and 1945.



Twin Vickers machine guns

Fiat CR.42 Falco Italy 1940



Top wing spans 31 ft 9½ in (9.7 m)

Bottom wing spans 21 ft 3½ in (6.5 m)

Wheels do not retract into the craft

Twin booms extend from body to rear tail planes



Lockheed P-38 Lightning USA 1941



Mitsubishi A6M5 Zero Japan 1943

Cannon mounted in the wing

Front windshield made of bulletproof glass

Rolls Royce Merlin 77 engine gives top speed of 417 mph (671 km/h)



Supermarine Spitfire PR MkX UK 1944

Wheels retract into the wing during flight

The famous German fighter ace, Baron Manfred von Richthofen, made 19 of his 80 “kills” in his **Fokker Dr.1** triplane. Fighter designs mostly moved from biplanes (with two pairs of wings) to monoplanes (with a single pair of wings) after World War I, and aircraft such as the **Hawker**

Hurricane Mk1 and the **Messerschmitt Bf 109E** battled in the sky. Some fighters, such as the **Mitsubishi A6M5 Zero**, also served as bombers, while the **Supermarine Spitfire PR MkX** relied on its speed to avoid other fighters as it took photos over enemy lines.